

Family reunion on my father's 90th birthday, July 2011.

After doing the staff college we both held the prestigious post of brigade major and subsequently, commanded our battalion/regiment. Both of us served in our respective Army HQs in the military operations directorate, in senior capacities. Later, as lieutenant generals, both Musharraf and I commanded the elite 1 Corps of Pakistani and Indian armies respectively. We are survivors, too: I was shot and seriously wounded by terrorists in Kashmir, and his car was blown up by a terrorist's bomb, and both of us have had a few more close brushes with death.

Finally, we became the army chiefs of our respective countries, and held this coveted appointment during the period 2005–07, though Musharraf had also appointed himself as the president after a coup in 1999. I retired on 30 September 2007, and was appointed by my government as the governor of Arunachal Pradesh in January 2008. In the case of Musharraf, though he reluctantly doffed his uniform in 2007, he continued wearing his other hat – that of the self-appointed president of Pakistan. Sadly for him, from that dizzy